

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Man now charged in 5 other killings

6 fatally shot over 10 months in 2020 on Southwest Side

By Caroline Kubzansky and Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

Chicago police and Cook County prosecutors on Wednesday announced new charges brought against a man who allegedly carried out a spate of “serial” killings on the city’s Southwest Side during a 10-month stretch in 2020.

Antonio Reyes, now 21, has been in the Cook County Jail since late 2020, already charged with one killing earlier that year. This week, CPD detectives and Cook County prosecutors accused Reyes of carrying out five more killings between March and November 2020.

“Today is a day to celebrate the determined police work that brought these charges, and hopefully we will get some measure of justice for the families of the victims,” Cook County State’s Attorney Eileen O’Neill Burke said at a Wednesday news conference at CPD headquarters. “It’s sad, it’s sad to think about a 17-year-old committing serial murders over the course of nine months (and) how many people were taken.”

Both O’Neill Burke and police Superintendent Larry Snelling noted the apparent randomness of the shootings.

“None of these people have ever met Antonio Reyes before and there’s no reason to suspect Antonio Reyes had any reason to target them, but that’s exactly what he did,” O’Neill Burke added.

Snelling pointed out one shooting that left a man dead as he was in a vehicle with three kids, all under age 10.

“These children were in a vehicle with the adult victim who was killed in a barrage of bullets,” Snelling said. “This speaks to the level of disregard

Turn to Killings, Page 5

ELECTION 2025 SUBURBAN PRIMARIES

Sweeping changes

Embattled Dolton mayor ousted in landslide as trustee promises to ‘clean house’

Will County Freedom Caucus head loses contentious township supervisor race



Dolton mayoral candidate Jason House thanks a supporter as he celebrates a victory in the village’s primary Tuesday. CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

By Robert McCoppin, Mike Nolan and R. Christian Smith
Chicago Tribune

Two high-profile politicians were ousted in reelection bids this week as change swept through south suburban Dolton and Homer Township.

Dolton Mayor Tiffany Henyard appeared to have lost in a landslide Tuesday to village Trustee Jason House, who campaigned on a promise to “clean house.” In Homer Township, Supervisor

Steve Balich, who headed the Will County Freedom Caucus, failed in his reelection bid, as well.

Neither official, however, is leaving politics immediately. Henyard remains Thornton Township supervisor, while Balich will continue as a Will County board member.

Henyard has been under federal investigation since at least last spring, when subpoenas were delivered to Dolton Village Hall and Thornton Township offices. Unofficial results show she was trounced by House, who garnered

88% of the vote.

“Today marks an end to a dark day in Dolton,” House told supporters. “Today marks the first day of the future.”

House emphasized community engagement, enhanced services and sustained growth during the campaign. Three trustees running on a slate with House also had substantial leads in their races.

Henyard has been under federal investigation since at least last spring, when subpoenas were delivered to Dolton Village Hall and Thornton Township offices.

House, who is chief financial officer for the Healthcare Consortium of Illinois, ran with and supported Henyard in 2021, but parted ways with her after a series of controversies. Trustees accused the mayor of failing to fully disclose how she was spending public funds.

Board members hired former Chicago Mayor Lori Lightfoot to investigate. She filed a report concluding that the village’s previously healthy finances turned into

Turn to Elections, Page 4

Health care program for noncitizens proves costly

By Jeremy Gorner and Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Gov. JB Pritzker’s administration vastly underestimated the cost and attraction of a pair of controversial programs that provide state-funded health insurance for immigrants who are not citizens, according to an audit report released Wednesday.

The programs have cost the state more than \$1.6 billion since the initiative began in late 2020 and also have been plagued by improper enrollments and a failure to move some recipients who were eligible into Medicaid, the traditional health insurance program for the poor that is jointly funded by the federal government, according to the report from Illinois Auditor General Frank Mautino’s office.

While widely supported by the Latino caucus in Springfield and other progressive lawmakers, the programs have been a source of tension among the Democrats who control the legislature and briefly derailed

Turn to Program, Page 2

INSIDE



ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor’s \$830M infrastructure bond wins narrow approval

City Council narrowly passed a hotly contested \$830 million infrastructure bond plan Wednesday backed by Mayor Brandon Johnson, right. Aldermen approved the plan in a 26-23 vote after Johnson’s administration proposed a version with clearer guardrails. While opponents decried the debt package as irresponsible, allies of the mayor defended it as a crucial way to fund infrastructure work. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Pritzker: US owes state \$2B

Gov. JB Pritzker signed a letter this week that presses the White House for nearly \$2 billion in federal funding for the state he says is being improperly withheld. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

Memo details federal layoffs

Agencies must develop plans to cut positions, says a memo distributed by the White House that sets into motion massive governmental changes. **Nation & World in Business, Page 6**

Chicago installing new speed cameras

Controversial plan part of attempt to balance the budget

By Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

Chicago will add 50 speed cameras as part of Mayor Brandon Johnson’s plan to balance this year’s budget, increasing the stock of the devices used to ticket drivers by 30% citywide.

The city’s Department of Transportation confirmed this week that it is “actively working” to install the 50 cameras this year but declined to share the locations, saying they have yet to be finalized.

Multiple aldermen told the Tribune CDOT officials called them in the past several days to float addresses in their wards for a new speed camera, all of which were intersections the aldermen said constituents had raised concerns about when it came to speeding and crashes.

The cameras are controversial. While some aldermen say they are a useful traffic

Turn to Cameras, Page 5

TODAY’S WEATHER



High 47 Low 31

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere 177th year No. 58 © Chicago Tribune

